

Laws of the Game -- Excerpt (Sample)

Law 11 -- Offside

A player is in an offside position if any part of the head, body, or feet is in the opponents' half of the field of play, excluding the halfway line, and any part of the head, body, or feet is nearer to the opponents' goal line than both the ball and the second-last opponent. The hands and arms of every player, including the goalkeepers, are not considered for this purpose.

A player is not in an offside position if level with the second-last opponent, or level with the last two opponents.

It is not an offence in itself to be in an offside position. A player in an offside position at the moment the ball is played or touched by a teammate is only penalised on becoming involved in active play by interfering with play, interfering with an opponent, or gaining an advantage by being in that position.

Law 12 -- Fouls and Misconduct: Handball

A direct free kick is awarded to the opposing team if a player handles the ball deliberately, except for a goalkeeper within their own penalty area.

It is a handball offence if a player deliberately touches the ball with their hand or arm, including moving the hand or arm towards the ball, or scores in the opponents' goal directly from their hand or arm, even if accidental.

It is usually an offence if a player touches the ball with their hand or arm when it has made their body unnaturally bigger, or touches the ball with their hand or arm when it is above the height of their shoulder, unless the player has deliberately played the ball and it then touches their own hand or arm.

It is not usually an offence if the ball touches a player's hand or arm directly from the player's own head or body, the head or body of another player who is close, or the player's own hand or arm when it is close to their body and does not make their body unnaturally bigger.